

Mercy Onyilo

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About Me

An experienced **Product Designer** with 3+ years designing for both B2B and B2C companies ranging from startups to freelance projects, which has given me a strong understanding of different user groups, product goals and business contexts. I take a practical, research-informed approach to design by identifying real user problems, simplifying complex workflows, and turning them into clear, functional interfaces. I focus on creating experiences that reduce friction, improve task efficiency, and help users achieve their goals with ease.

Key Skills

End-to-end product design | User flows & information architecture | Wireframing | High fidelity UI design | Design documentation | User research | User feedback synthesis | User journey mapping & personas | Usability testing & validation | Cross-functional communication | Prototyping | Data-informed design | Design systems

Work Experience

Initium Design Academy

UI/UX Instructor | March 2025 - Present

- Developed curriculum modules and project briefs that helped **75%+** of students complete portfolio-ready case studies.
- Provided 1:1 mentorship, enabling **over 30 students** to build foundational design skills and improve confidence using design tools.
- Taught UI/UX principles and tools to classes of 15-20 students per cohort, improving average project quality by **60%** through structured lessons and hands-on exercises.

Freelance Designer

Product Designer | April 2024 - Present

- Conducted user research and usability tests that identified pain points and boosted usability across projects by **25–40%**.
- Led brainstorming sessions with clients to develop user-centered designs.
- Contributed to redesigning mobile onboarding screens, improving task completion rate by **35%** and reducing user drop-off.

Spire Africa

Product Design Intern | August 2022 - January 2023

- Simplified the notification bar, improving user visibility and feedback response by **45%**.
- Conducted user/design research and created mood boards that streamlined project alignment, reducing decision-making time by **30%**.
- Synthesized user insights into design recommendations, improving feature usability by **20%**.
- Collaborated with engineering and product teams to deliver an MVP used by **500+ early users**.

Roadrunner

Product Designer [Contract] | May 2022 - July 2022

- Assisted in building and documenting reusable UI components, improving consistency by **70%** and reducing design-developer handoff by **30%**.
- Designed wireframes, mockups, and prototypes for key features used by a user base of **200+ early adopters**.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to improve product flows, increasing task efficiency by **25%**.

MyEstate NG

UI/UX Designer [Contract] | April 2022 - May 2022

- Upgraded a communication interface that improved user messaging efficiency by **40%**.
 - Delivered complete wireframes and interactive prototypes that reduced development iterations by **50%**.
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Education

- B.Agriculture [Agricultural Economics] | Joseph Sarwuan Tarka University, Makurdi |2023